MUSIC

In the Fast Lane

*True to his name, rapper **Raftaar** maintains a heady pace–juggling rapping with entrepreneurship and, now, acting in a web series*

There is perhaps a reason why Dilin Nair rechristened himself as Raftaar. And it's not just to do with his immense talent for rapping. "I've been known for speaking my heart out. Now, of course, I have mellowed," says Raftaar. Aside from being in the news for mincing no words in his art, or in life, Raftaar also has a penchant for trying out everything under the sun while pushing the envelope as an entertainer. The sheer pace at which he hops into diverse projects leaves fans breathless. The occasional reality-show judge and former choreographer also has a slew of endorsements in his kitty. In his trademark style, he says, "Raftaar means speed, I see no point in slowing down!"

The ace singer-songwriter has added another feather to his cap with his debut as an actor with JioCinema's web series *Bajao*, where he plays Babbar. "This character is exactly how I was when I started out. I have grown and he is growing as the show progresses. I identify a lot with him," says Raftaar. The series follows the hilarious escapades of three young filmmakers, navigating the high-octane world of Punjabi pop music.

Raftaar, who has given us chartbusters like 'Swag Mera Desi', 'Lonely', 'Damn' and 'Sick', and has also been a choreographer early in his career, was rather apprehensive about his acting debut. "I'll be honest. I wasn't sure of being able to act. One of the first scenes we shot was a party sequence. I downed two tequila shots because I had to be drunk for the scene. That was a party and shoot at the same time and the 'method' helped," he laughs.

Speaking about the fountainhead of Raftaar's multitasking energy, long-time friend, mentor and business partner Ankit Khanna says, "Raftaar is pure energy! And that energy comes out in many ways. I have seen him

"Babbar is exactly how I was when I started out. I identify a lot with him," says Raftaar about his character in Bajao

